

Charter International Conference on Engineering Adaptive and Self-Managing Systems (SEAMS)

This Charter defines the duties and policies for the SEAMS Steering Committee and the key roles to the annual organization of SEAMS

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I. SEAMS Mission

SEAMS is the primary scientific event on engineering self-adaptive and self-managing systems. It provides researchers and practitioners with a forum to present, investigate, discuss, examine and advance the fundamental principles, the state-of-the-art, and the solutions addressing critical challenges of engineering self-adaptive and self-managing systems.

SEAMS was founded by Rogério de Lemos, David Garlan, Hausi Müller, and Marin Litoiu. SEAMS started as a workshop in 2006, collocated with the International Conference on Software Engineering (ICSE). In 2011 it became a symposium and in 2014 a conference. SEAMS is organized annually.

Thematic scope

SEAMS targets advances and breakthroughs beyond the state-of-the-art on self-adaptive and self-managing systems. It covers all aspects of engineering self-adaptive and self-managing systems, ranging from foundations and theory to technology and their applications.

Finances and Sponsorship

The SEAMS organization is funded from the symposium registration and possibly additional sponsoring actions. SEAMS is usually co-sponsored by ACM and IEEE Computer Society.

Geographical Scope and Frequency

SEAMS is a global event that is held yearly around May. SEAMS is usually collocated with the International Conference on Software Engineering (ICSE).

Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion

Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion are central to the realization of the SEAMS mission. SEAMS fosters an environment where all individuals are entitled to participate in any activity free of discrimination. This applies to team compositions, including but not limited to Steering Committee and symposium organizing committees. SEAMS meetings and symposia must provide a welcoming, open, and safe environment that embraces the value of every person, regardless of race, color, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, age, marital status, religion, national origin, ancestry, or disability.

II. Purpose of the SEAMS Charter

The SEAMS charter defines the duties and policies for:

- The SEAMS Steering Committee (hereafter named the Steering Committee) and its Chair (hereafter named the SC Chair).
- The SEAMS General Chair(s) (hereafter named the General Chair).
- The SEAMS Program Committee Chairs (hereafter named the Program Chairs).

The SEAMS Charter may be modified according to the following process:

- Modifications may be proposed by any member of the Steering Committee to the SC Chair.
- To be adopted modifications must be approved by two-thirds of the members of the Steering Committee.

III. Selection of SEAMS Organizers

A. Selection of General Chair

The Steering Committee fosters and selects proposals for General Chair candidates. Proposals for General Chairs need to be submitted to the SC Chair two years before the actual date of SEAMS.

A proposal for General Chair candidates may include an initial list of names for Program Chairs, and other Organizing Committee members.

The members of the Steering Committee discuss the proposals and try to reach a consensus. If necessary, anonymous voting is organized and the candidate for General Chair with the highest number of votes is selected (in case of a tie, the SC Chair decides). Candidates can be ranked.

The SC Chair invites the highest-ranked candidate for availability and commitment to the duty. If the candidate does not accept, the next candidate is invited, etc.

B. Selection of Program Chairs for SEAMS

Two Program Chairs are selected as follows:

- a. The General Chair proposes a list of candidates for Program Chair to the SC Chair (name, link to home page, and summary of experience as Program Chair)
- b. The SC Chair consults with the Steering Committee, advises the General Chair on these names, and may also suggest additional or reject proposed names.
- c. The General Chair invites Program Chairs based on this advice and finally notifies the SC Chair of the name of the designated Program Chairs.

C. Selection of SEAMS Organizing Committee

The General Chair selects the additional members of the Organizing Committee of SEAMS.

IV. Duties of the General Chair

The duties of the General Chair for SEAMS comprise the following:

- Propose the names of candidate Program Chairs and interact with the SC Chair to select two Program Chairs respecting equity, diversity, and inclusion.
- Assign a Chair for the Most Influential Paper award.
- Managing the selection of the Community Debate chair (CD chair). Please refer to Appendix 2 for details.
- Determine the other members of the Organizing Committee possibly in interaction with the Program Chairs. This includes chairs for specific tracks in the program, such as artifact chair, industry chair, journal-first, and doctoral symposium chair.
- Secure the infrastructure for organizing SEAMS, with the ICSE organizers if SEAMS is colocated with ICSE.
- Arrange for proceedings publication possibly in collaboration with a proceedings chair, and with ACM and IEEE if they serve as technical co-sponsors.
- Establish a symposium calendar and track activities accordingly.
- Establish a conference management system, possibly in collaboration with the Program Chairs.
- Be responsible for managing the symposium funding and ensuring, as much as humanly possible, that the symposium does not run a deficit. The SEAMS Steering Committee will support the actions of the General Chair.
- Consult the SC Chair for any changes to the accepted proposal for organizing and running the symposium.
- Establish a website for the symposium and social media channels, possibly collaborating with supporting publicity chairs.
- Oversee the quality and content of the SEAMS website.
- Ensure a SEAMS program that appeals to researchers and engineers (when appropriate) including research sessions, keynotes, industrial and other tracks.
- Disseminate the Call for Papers and Call for Participation possibly collaborating with publicity chairs.
- Promote SEAMS to ensure a robust participation of senior and junior researchers and industry practitioners in relation to industry-related events.
- Report the plans for their SEAMS at the SC meeting the year before their SEAMS. Besides the regular plans, any novelty should be clarified and requires discussion and approval from the SC.
- Prepare a report for the Steering Committee after the symposium.

Restrictions:

- The General Chair cannot submit papers to the symposium.

V. Duties of the Program Chairs

The duties of the Program Chairs comprise the following:

- Prepare and propose the composition of the Program Committee, in consultation with the General Chair.
- Ensure that all members in the composition of the Program Committee are competent to review papers on engineering self-adaptive and self-managing systems.
- Ensure that there is balanced membership on the Program Committee regarding thematic coverage, geography, and experience level as well as promote equity,

diversity, and inclusion.

- Develop a Call for Papers and deliver it to the General Chair for distribution in accordance with the timeline.
- Develop and follow a well-defined peer-review procedure for research papers.
- Ensure that papers obtain high-quality reviews and that papers are selected fairly.
- Ensure that all submitters receive acceptance or rejection notices on time and that rejections are accompanied by written feedback, including the acceptance rate.
- Ensure the quality of SEAMS as a top-ranked conference (A-ranked conference based on relevant criteria, in particular, the quality of accepted papers and its acceptance rate, e.g., the acceptance rate of full research papers around 20%).
- Ensure that camera-ready papers are properly prepared for publication in the proceedings.
- Prepare a balanced and attractive program for SEAMS.
- Oversee the final program of SEAMS with the GC and in consultation with the other chairs.
- Editors of the main proceedings can be either the Program Chairs or the Program Chairs with the General Chair.
- Initiate in consultation with the General Chair the organization of a Special Issue with the best papers of SEAMS (revised and extended versions). An option is ACM Transactions on Autonomous and Adaptive Systems (TAAS).
- Consult the General Chair for any changes to the accepted way of organizing and running the symposium.
- Assist the General Chair in preparing the final report to the Steering Committee.

Besides the regular information about the symposium, the final report should also include:

- The list of Program Committee members that provided a good service to the Program Committee and those that provided a bad service to the Program Committee (frequent delays, missing reviews, reviews of poor quality).
- The list of authors that did not present his/her paper – no-show.

Restrictions:

- Program Chairs cannot submit papers to the symposium.

VI. Duties of the Steering Committee Chair

The duties of the SC Chair comprise:

- Be responsible for applying the SEAMS Charter and controlling future modifications.
- Be responsible for maintaining the quality of SEAMS as a top event on engineering self-adaptive and self-managing systems.
- Ensure that the General and Program Chairs know the SEAMS expectations and policies.
- Chair the yearly Steering Committee meetings, interim e-mail discussions, and videoconferences.
- Interact regularly with the General Chair to learn the status of symposium activities and to advise and guide decisions.
- Handle unexpected issues regarding an appointed General Chair that may impact the

- organization of SEAMS, if needed in consultation with the Steering Committee.
- Communicate major symposium status milestones to the Steering Committee.
- Maintain the repository of the history of SEAMS symposia and insights to help prepare future SEAMSs (with access to Steering Committee members only).
 - Maintain a record of the Organizing Committees for all SEAMSs.
 - Maintain a record of symposia results (acceptance rates, attendance, programs, tracks, etc.) for all SEAMSs.
 - Maintain the set of artifacts from previous SEAMSs that can help chairs plan future symposia, including realized budgets and relevant artifacts for the symposia ranking.
- Interact with other conferences to nurture cooperation and avoid conflicts.
- Ensure the yearly application to the appropriate bodies, e.g., CORE, to have SEAMS ranked.

The SC Chair may ask assistance from members of the Steering Committee.

VII. Duties of the Steering Committee

The duties of the members of the Steering Committee comprise:

- Contribute to the realisation of the SEAMS mission.
- Support future modifications of the SEAMS Charter.
- Participate actively in the Steering Committee meetings (in person and online).
- Support the selection of the GC and PC chairs of yearly SEAMS symposia.
- Assist the SC Chair in other duties where applicable.

VIII. Steering Committee Composition

The Steering Committee is updated yearly according to the following rules.

A. Rules for Composition

- The general and program chairs of the next edition(s):
 - SEAMS at year+1.
 - SEAMS at year+2.
- The chairs of the current edition:
 - SEAMS at the current year.
- The chairs of the past two editions:
 - SEAMS at year-1.
 - SEAMS at year-2.
- The founders of SEAMS. The founders decide themselves when they want to end their membership of the SEAMS Steering Committee.
- Service members. At most two key community members with a role similar to the founding members ensuring the continuity of the "SEAMS culture." These members are proposed by the SEAMS SC for five years and can be extended once for five years.
- Publicity strategy liaison. Takes care of a "publicity strategy" with responsibilities related to different aspects of publicity of SEAMS over time. This person will be a key point of contact for the publicity chairs of different SEAMS editions. Ensuring a fast

take up of novel technologies and developments will be key. This member is proposed by the SEAMS SC for five years and can be extended once for five years.

- One representative of the Steering Committee of ACSOS (International Conference on Autonomic Computing and Self Organizing Systems) (without voting rights) who is proposed by the ACSOS Steering Committee and agreed upon by the SEAMS SC.

B. Update of the Composition

- At the yearly Steering Committee meeting organized with or around the time of the SEAMS symposium.

C. Election of Steering Committee Chair

- The Steering Committee Chair will be elected among its members:
 - Among declared candidates.
 - By voting with a majority.
 - Mandate: 2 years (can be re-elected twice).

IX. Journal-first Track

SEAMS may incorporate a journal-first track, which should be managed by one or two journal-first track chairs, who will coordinate with the PC Chair(s) to incorporate the presentation of accepted journal-first contributions within the SEAMS program either in a specialized session or in regular sessions that match the topic of the contribution.

Journal-first submissions must adhere to the following criteria:

- The paper was accepted to TAAS or another JCR Q1/Q2 journal not earlier than December 1, two years before the conference and no later than the submission deadline for the journal-first track (e.g., for the 2026 edition, articles should have been accepted not earlier than December 1st, 2024) .
- The paper is in the scope of SEAMS.
- The paper reports completely new research results or presents novel contributions not previously reported in prior work. The paper does not extend prior work solely with additional proofs or algorithms (or other such details presented for completeness), additional empirical results, or minor enhancements or variants of the results presented in the prior work.
- The paper has not been presented at, and is not under consideration for, journal-first programs of other conferences.

X. SEAMS Awards

The following awards will be delivered annually at SEAMS:

- SEAMS Best Paper Award.
- SEAMS Best Student Paper Award.
- SEAMS Best Artifact Award.
- SEAMS Most Influential Paper Award.

A. SEAMS Best Paper Award

- This award is given to the best full paper.
- The Program Chairs nominate three papers considering review grades and suggestions from Program Committee members.
- The designated Sub-Committee of (at least three members of) the Program Committee selects the best full paper by vote. Members should be senior and have no conflict of interest with the nominated papers.

B. SEAMS Best Student Paper Award

- This award is given to the best full paper with a student as first author.
- The Program Chairs nominate three papers considering review grades and suggestions from Program Committee members.
- The designated Sub-Committee of at least three Program Committee members selects the best full paper by vote. Members should be senior and have no conflict of interest with the nominated papers.

C. SEAMS Best Artifact Award

- This award is given to the best artifact given that there are at least three accepted artifacts.
- The Artifact Chair nominates three artifacts considering review grades and suggestions from Artifacts Program Committee members.
- The designated Sub-Committee of at least three Artifacts Program Committee members selects the best artifact by vote. Members should be a mix of senior and junior and have no conflict of interest with the nominated papers.

D. SEAMS Most Influential Paper Award (MIP Award)

- This MIP Award is given to the most influential paper of the edition of SEAMS in year -10.
- The appointed MIP Chair puts together a designated Sub-Committee of (at least 4) senior members of the community to select the winner of the MIP Award.
- The selection of the MIP Award should consider all papers published in the edition of SEAMS 10 years ago based on different aspects of impact, including, generated citations, spawning of new lines of research, and direct or indirect industrial adoption, among others.
- In addition to the MIP Award, the MIP Sub-committee may award up to two “Honourable Mention” certificates to other outstanding candidate papers not selected for the award.

Appendix 1. Composition of the Steering Committee

Composition of the SEAMS Steering Committee April 28, 2025:

- Luciano Baresi, Polytechnic University of Milan, Italy (member)
- Amel Bennaceur, The Open University, United Kingdom (PC 2026)
- Radu Calinescu, University of York, UK (member)*
- Javier Camara, University of Málaga, Spain (member and chair)
- Siobhán Clarke, Trinity College Dublin, Ireland (GC 2025)
- Rogerio de Lemos, University of Kent, UK (founding member)
- David Garlan, Carnegie Mellon University, USA (founding member)
- Pooyan Jamshidi, University of South Carolina, USA (member)*
- Eunsuk Kang, Carnegie Mellon University, USA (PC 2026)
- Marin Litoiu, York University, Canada (founding member)
- Xiaoxing Ma, Nanjing University, China (member)
- Raffaella Mirandola, Polytechnic University of Milan, Italy (member)*
- Shiva Nejati, University of Ottawa, Canada (PC 2025)
- Liliana Pasquale, University College Dublin, Ireland (member)
- Thomas Vogel, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany (PC 2025)
- Andrea Zisman, The Open University, United Kingdom (GC 2026)
- Antonio Bucchiarone (member from ACSOS).

*Members that rotate off the SC after SEAMS 2025.

Appendix 2. SEAMS Community Debate Procedure

Phase 1: Managed by the General Chair

1. The General Chair will be responsible for managing the selection of the Community Debate chair (CD chair).
2. The GC prepares a Call for Proposals for the Community Debate. Such a proposal may comprise:
 - a. A thought-provoking statement on a topic of broad interest to the community. The statement should allow members of the community to take a position in favour or against it.
 - b. A motivation for the statement with arguments.
 - c. A brief bio of the proposer.
 - d. A proposal should not exceed 500 words.
3. The GC distributes the Call for Proposals for the Community Debate and collects the proposals.
4. The GC in consultation with the SEAMS SC selects a proposal based on the timeliness of the topic, the suitability of the statement for organizing a debate, and the qualification of the proposer.
5. The GC notifies:
 - a. The proposers of rejected statements with a brief motivation.
 - b. The proposer of the accepted statement with feedback provided by the SEAMS SC.
6. The proposer of the accepted statement becomes the Community Debate chair (CD chair) who will be responsible for the remainder of the process.

Phase 2: Managed by the Community Debate Chair

7. The CD chair puts together a small review committee of seniors (4 persons may be enough)
5. The CD chair prepares a Call for Community Debate positions (CD positions). Such a position may comprise:
 - a. An explicit position in favor or against the statement.
 - b. Arguments for the position supported by references where needed.
 - c. A short bio of the submitter.
 - d. A position should not exceed 2 pages in the proceedings.
6. The CD chair manages the review process of the positions with the review committee. Review criteria may include the clarity of the position and the relevance and validity of the arguments.
7. The CD chair notifies the submitters, accepted and rejected.
8. In case there is an imbalance between “in favor” and “against” the statement of the accepted positions, the CD chair may invite a few additional people from the community to prepare a position. These positions may undergo a light review.
9. The CD chair collects the camera-ready papers, checks them, and transfers the papers to the publicity chair.
10. The CD chair prepares the Community Debate session and disseminates the necessary information via the SEAMS website.
11. The CD chair coordinates the Community Debate session. The debate may:
 - a. Provide submitters of accepted positions a few minutes of podium time (three to a maximum of five minutes should be fine).

- b. Allocates the main part of the session to a debate with the SEAMS attendees.
 - c. The CD chair wraps up the discussion at the end of the debate.
- 12. The CD chair makes sure that the outcome of the debate is disseminated via the communication channels.

Appendix 3. List of Organizing Committee Roles

- General Chair
- Program Chair
- Artifact Chair
- Journal-first Chair
- Proceedings Chair
- Web Chair
- Publicity Chair
- MIP Award Chair
- Social Media Chair
- Community Debate Chair (Selected by the GC following the procedure described in Appendix 2, Phase 1).

Currently deprecated roles:

- Doctoral Symposium Chair
- Industry Chair

Appendix 4. Publicity Strategy

Goals

- Advertise SEAMS and disseminate SEAMS information to our community, researchers in related communities, and industry.
- Strengthen SEAMS and our community.
- Increase our community and SEAMS in terms of numbers of submissions and participation.

Roles

- **Web chair** to take care of the SEAMS website.
- One, or preferably two **social media chairs** for the social media channels.
- **Publicity chair** responsible for disseminating SEAMS through mailing lists.
- Possibly multiple publicity chairs (regional) to target audiences based on various geographical regions.
- The roles and responsibilities of the publicity chair and social media chair can be combined to the role of **publicity and social media chair**.

Protocol

Actions before SEAMS

- **Early actions**
 - Set up the website on conf.researchr.org
 - Take over social media channels from the previous SEAMS edition
- **Continual actions**
 - Update website whenever new information is available
- **When the Call for Papers is ready**
 - Announce call through website, mailing lists, and social media channels
 - Earlier (when the call is ready) and a later call (four to six weeks before the submission deadline) should be sent to the SEAMS mailing list
- **When the Call for Participation is ready**
 - Announce call through website, mailing lists, and social media channels
- Intermediate, “smaller” news should be published independently through the **website** and **social media channels** such as keynote speakers confirmed, program is ready, registration is open, early registration closes soon, updates to deadlines, sponsors, conference dinner, ...
- Important news should be posted to the **SEAMS mailing list** such as calls, registration to SEAMS, and deadline updates
- Provide content for **social media channels**. Be creative, for instance:
 - “People of SEAMS 20XX” to present the/some committee members
 - “A taste of SEAMS” to present past SEAMS papers such as those that have been awarded in the past

Actions during SEAMS

- Live tweeting / blogging from SEAMS on social media (mainly Twitter/X)
- Update website with news such as changes of the program

Actions after SEAMS

- Announce award winners on the website and social media channels.
- Announce and link the proceedings when they are available on the website and social media channels.
- Hand over social media channels to next year's SEAMS OC.
- Optional: provide a conference summary on the website and social media
- Optional: Add a picture of SEAMS to the website.

Final notes on the concrete publicity strategy

- Can be adapted from the proposed actions before, during, and after SEAMS
- Should be developed by the organization committee, especially the publicity, web, and social media chairs, paying close attention to the timeline (e.g., call for participation should be sent out before the early registration deadline).
- Should be discussed in the whole organization committee.
- Contact Thomas Vogel (SEAMS steering committee member for publicity strategy liaison) for questions.